

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

No-Show Reduction Initiative

SalonBookr — SalonOS Platform

Document Type	Business Requirements Document (BRD)
Product	SalonBookr (SalonOS B2B SaaS Platform)
Initiative	Appointment No-Show Reduction
Owner	Product / Business Team
Status	Draft for Review
Version	2.0 — see Revision History below
Related Document	Functional Requirements Document (FRD) — No-Show Reduction Initiative

Revision History

Version	Change	Summary
1.0	Initial release	Reminder System, Waitlist Management (slot recovery), and mandatory Pre-Payment Collection
2.0	Scope revision	Waitlist Management redefined as Live Delay Tracker (real-time delay updates, reschedule at 60+ min); Pre-Payment changed from salon-mandated to fully elective, incentivized with a discount and Priority Service

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1. Executive Summary

SalonBookr is a SalonOS platform that enables beauty salons to manage appointments, customer relationships, staff operations, analytics, and online bookings through a centralized system.

Operational analysis across salons on the platform shows an average appointment no-show rate of approximately 40%, observed consistently across both traditional call-based bookings and online bookings made through SalonBookr. High no-show rates result in direct revenue loss, underutilized appointment capacity, scheduling inefficiencies, and reduced customer satisfaction for salon partners.

This initiative proposes three appointment management capabilities to address the problem:

- Appointment Reminders — delivered via WhatsApp
- Live Delay Tracker — delivered via WhatsApp
- Optional Online Pre-Payment — processed via Razorpay, incentivized through a percentage discount and priority service

The business objective of this initiative is to reduce the average appointment no-show rate from 40% to 30% within six months of feature rollout, while improving appointment utilization and strengthening SalonBookr's value proposition for salon owners.

2. Business Problem Statement

Beauty salons on the SalonBookr platform experience significant revenue and scheduling disruption due to customers failing to attend booked appointments. The current no-show behavior creates a chain of operational issues:

- Customers forget they have an upcoming appointment and arrive late, rush to attend, or skip it entirely.
- Customers decide to cancel but do so at the last minute, leaving no time for the salon to fill the vacated slot.
- Salons lack visibility into which other customers would be interested in a newly cancelled slot, so the slot frequently goes unfilled.
- A single late or extended appointment cascades into delays for every appointment scheduled afterward that day.
- Customers waiting due to cascading delays become dissatisfied, and some cancel, reschedule, or switch to a different salon.
- Salons lose revenue from appointment capacity that goes unused as a direct result of no-shows and unfilled cancellations.

Current average no-show rate (across call and online bookings): 40%

3. Business Objective

Primary Objective

Reduce the average appointment no-show rate from 40% to 30% within six months of feature rollout.

Secondary Objectives

- Improve overall appointment attendance rate.
- Increase utilization of slots vacated by cancellations.
- Improve proactive customer communication around appointments.
- Reduce revenue loss caused by missed appointments.
- Improve customer experience through more predictable, on-time scheduling.

4. Current State Analysis

4.1 Existing SalonBookr Platform Features

- Salon Website
- Booking Link
- Appointment Calendar
- CRM
- Analytics Dashboard
- Employee Management
- WhatsApp Plugin Integration

4.2 Current Booking Journey

1. Customer books an appointment (via call or online booking link).
2. Appointment is added to the salon's calendar.
3. No structured reminder process exists today.
4. Customer may forget the appointment as the date approaches.
5. Customer either attends, cancels late, reschedules, or does not show up at all.

4.3 Resulting Gaps

- High no-show rate (40% average) across both booking channels.
- Direct revenue loss from unused appointment capacity.
- Inefficient schedule utilization, with no mechanism to recover cancelled slots.

5. Proposed Solution

SalonBookr will introduce three new modules, each targeting a distinct contributor to the no-show problem:

Feature	Primary Channel	Business Purpose
Appointment Reminder System	WhatsApp	Reduce no-shows caused by customers forgetting appointments
Live Delay Tracker	WhatsApp	Keep customers informed of real-time appointment delays and offer rescheduling when delays are significant
Pre-Payment Collection (Optional)	Razorpay	Increase customer commitment through an elective discount and priority-service incentive, rather than a payment requirement

6. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Interest / Role
Salon Owners	Primary platform customers; adopt and configure the features for their salons
Salon Customers (End Consumers)	Receive reminders and delay updates; may elect to pre-pay for a discount and priority service
Product Team	Own feature design, delivery, and rollout
Analytics Team	Build and maintain KPI tracking for no-show rate and related metrics
Sales Team	Communicate new capabilities to prospective and existing salons
Customer Success Team	Onboard salons onto the new features and provide ongoing support

7. Business Requirements

The following requirements are expressed at business intent level. Detailed system behavior and acceptance criteria are specified separately in the companion Functional Requirements Document (FRD).

7.1 Appointment Reminders

BR-1: The platform shall reduce missed appointments by proactively communicating upcoming appointment details to customers ahead of time.

BR-2: Reminder communication shall occur at multiple points before the appointment, escalating in urgency as the appointment approaches.

BR-3: Salons shall be able to configure an additional, closer-to-time reminder for customers who need extra prompting.

BR-4: Customers shall be able to reschedule or cancel directly from a reminder message, reducing the chance of a silent no-show.

7.2 Live Delay Tracker

Note: This module was originally scoped as “Waitlist Management” (slot recovery for cancellations). Based on revised business direction, it has been redefined to address running delays during the appointment day — a root cause identified in Section 2.

BR-5: The platform shall keep customers informed, through real-time WhatsApp updates, of how delayed their appointment is running relative to their original scheduled time.

BR-6: Salons shall be able to configure delay notification cadence and the reschedule threshold from their SalonOS settings.

BR-7: When a delay becomes significant (greater than 60 minutes), the platform shall offer the customer the option to reschedule rather than continue waiting indefinitely.

7.3 Pre-Payment Collection (Optional)

Pre-payment is fully elective. Customers are never required to pay in advance to book an appointment; pre-payment is offered as an incentivized choice.

BR-8: Salons shall be able to offer customers the option to pre-pay, partially or fully, for any service in exchange for a discount and priority service. Customers who decline shall proceed through the standard no-payment booking flow.

BR-9: Payment shall be processed securely through a trusted payment gateway (Razorpay).

BR-10: Where a customer chooses to pre-pay, the appointment shall be confirmed only once payment is completed successfully.

BR-11: The platform shall reward customers who pre-pay with a salon-configurable percentage discount on their total bill, making pre-payment an attractive choice rather than a requirement.

BR-12: The platform shall give pre-paid customers priority service, minimizing the delay they experience compared to non-prepaid customers.

8. User Stories

Salon Owner

- As a salon owner, I want customers to receive reminders so that fewer appointments are missed.
- As a salon owner, I want to notify customers proactively when my salon is running behind schedule, so they are not caught off guard.
- As a salon owner, I want to offer a discount and priority service to customers who pre-pay, so more customers choose to commit upfront — without forcing payment on anyone.

Salon Customer

- As a customer, I want appointment reminders so that I do not forget my booking.
- As a customer, I want to know in real time how delayed my appointment is running, so I can plan my time accordingly.

- As a customer, I want the option to reschedule if the salon is running very late, so I do not waste my time waiting indefinitely.
- As a customer, I want the choice to pay in advance for a discount and faster service, without being required to, so pre-paying feels worthwhile rather than mandatory.

9. Success Metrics (KPIs)

9.1 Primary KPI

Metric: Appointment No-Show Rate

Formula: No-Show Rate = (Missed Appointments ÷ Total Appointments) × 100

Baseline: 40%

Target: 30% within 6 months of rollout

9.2 Secondary KPIs

Metric	Formula	Target
Reminder Engagement Rate	Customers interacting with reminder messages ÷ Reminders sent	60%
Appointment Attendance Rate	Attended appointments ÷ Total appointments	+10% increase
Delay Update Delivery Rate	Delay updates successfully delivered ÷ Delay updates triggered	95%
Reschedule-via-Delay Rate	Appointments rescheduled after 60+ min delay ÷ Appointments that crossed the 60-min threshold	70%
Pre-Payment Adoption Rate	Prepaid appointments ÷ Total eligible appointments	55%
Priority Service On-Time Rate	Pre-paid appointments started within 5 min of scheduled time ÷ Total pre-paid appointments	90%

10. Scope

10.1 In Scope

- WhatsApp appointment confirmation and reminder messages
- Real-time delay calculation and WhatsApp delay status updates
- Razorpay payment gateway integration
- Reminder scheduling logic (24-hour, 2-hour, 1-hour, optional 30-minute)

- Delay-triggered reschedule flow (offered when delay exceeds 60 minutes)
- Optional pre-payment collection (customer-elective) and payment status tracking
- Pre-payment discount configuration and calculation
- Priority service tagging and delay-minimization logic for pre-paid customers

10.2 Out of Scope

- SMS reminders
- Email reminders
- Loyalty programs
- Dynamic pricing
- AI-based demand forecasting
- Multi-payment gateway support (beyond Razorpay)
- Automatic refund management
- Customer review collection
- Guaranteed zero-delay SLA for any customer, including Priority Service customers
- Stacking pre-payment discounts with other promotions or loyalty offers
- Mandatory pre-payment requirements (pre-payment is elective in all cases)

11. Assumptions

- Salons have an active WhatsApp Business integration configured on SalonBookr.
- Customers provide valid, reachable phone numbers at the time of booking.
- Razorpay services remain available and operational.
- Customers are willing to engage with salons through WhatsApp communication.
- Salons configure their pre-payment discount and priority service settings correctly for the services they choose to offer it on.
- Salons maintain reasonably accurate real-time appointment status (e.g., marking services as started or completed) so delay calculations reflect actual salon conditions.

12. Risks

Risk	Business Impact
Customers ignore reminder or delay messages	Reduced effectiveness of the reminder and delay tracking features
WhatsApp message delivery failures	Customers miss notifications entirely
Payment gateway downtime	Customers unable to complete pre-payment when they choose to
Inaccurate real-time delay estimates	Customer mistrust of delay updates; reputational risk if updates are wrong

Discount used without genuine commitment (e.g., pre-pay then frequently reschedule)	Margin erosion without the intended reduction in no-shows
Salon staff unable to honor Priority Service commitments	Pre-paid customers experience delays despite paying for priority, damaging trust in the feature
Salon staff resistance to adoption	Reduced feature utilization and weaker impact on no-show rate

13. Dependencies

- WhatsApp Business API integration
- Razorpay payment gateway integration
- Appointment scheduling service (existing calendar module)
- Real-time appointment status tracking (start/completion timestamps) to support live delay calculation
- Customer CRM database
- Analytics tracking infrastructure

14. Non-Goals

This initiative is explicitly not intended to:

- Eliminate all appointment no-shows.
- Replace existing salon scheduling workflows.
- Automate employee scheduling.
- Predict future customer attendance behavior.
- Optimize salon pricing strategy.
- Eliminate salon scheduling delays at the source — the platform communicates and manages delay, it does not prevent it.

15. Operational Readiness Checklist

Prior to launch, the following teams must confirm readiness:

Product Team

- ☐ Feature development completed
- ☐ UAT completed
- ☐ Production deployment completed

Analytics Team

- ☐ KPI dashboards created
- ☐ No-show rate tracking implemented
- ☐ Delay tracking implemented
- ☐ Payment conversion tracking implemented
- ☐ Discount redemption tracking implemented

Sales Team

- ☐ Feature training completed
- ☐ Feature documentation distributed
- ☐ Sales enablement materials updated

Customer Success Team

- ☐ Salon onboarding guide updated
- ☐ Support FAQs prepared
- ☐ Escalation workflows documented

16. Expected Business Outcome

Implementation of the Reminder, Live Delay Tracker, and Pre-Payment features is expected to:

- Reduce the average no-show rate from 40% to 30%.
- Improve overall appointment attendance.
- Reduce customer dissatisfaction caused by unexplained delays.
- Convert potential walk-outs into reschedules rather than lost revenue and lost goodwill.
- Increase pre-payment adoption through discount and priority-service incentives, without forcing payment on any customer.
- Improve customer satisfaction through better scheduling predictability and transparency.
- Strengthen SalonBookr's value proposition for salon owners as a complete SalonOS platform.

This initiative directly supports SalonBookr's broader goal of improving salon operational efficiency and maximizing appointment-based revenue.